

Introduction

Autodesk 3ds Max is a very powerful software with integrated 3D modelling, animation, rendering, and compositing tools that enable visual graphic artists and CG designers an effective and faster solution to bring 3D graphics into production.

Graphic design and 3D modelling is more of an art and requires a creative aptitude rather than strict theoretical knowledge. But with the advent of very fast processing capabilities and advances in motion graphics, it becomes empirical to be abreast with the latest software in 3D and how to use them. The applications and scope of 3D design is plenty. People these days are either programmers or artists and there are very few people who are both.

With the introduction of software such as 3ds Max, this gap could be bridged. 3ds Max is the perfect package for people who are stuck between the two choices. 3ds Max can be as technical as you would ever want, yet it still allows an artist to easily create stunningly beautiful images. For the artist, learning something as technical as 3ds Max can seem daunting, and for technical people, creating a beautiful image can be challenging. This Fast Track aims to get you up to speed with the most primary uses of 3ds Max so that you can experiment yourself and follow along on the path you want.

This edition is certainly not an authoritative book on 3ds Max and obviously does not explain everything there is to explain in the vast world of 3d modeling. The software in itself is so robust and complicated; it would take a lot more to dwell into the details of the working of the software. We just try to cover the basics of modeling, texturing, lighting, rendering and special effects. Any further areas like building games and integrating CG graphics into video is beyond the scope of this edition. But none the less, this Fast Track is an attempt to give you a basic understanding and arm you with the right tools to take it further. 